

DRINKING from your Water Heater

Step 1: Keep the water in the tank clean. Shut off water to the house. If you can't do that, close the valve that lets water into the water heater.

Step 2: Cut off power to the tank.

- ELECTRIC: flip the breaker supplying electricity to the appliance.
- GAS: shut off the gas to the tank.

Step 3: Allow the water to cool. This will take hours!

Step 4: Attach a hose. Attach a washing machine / garden hose to the valve at the bottom of the tank.

Step 5: Break the vacuum. Turn on a hot water faucet in the house to allow air into the tank.

Step 6: Collect the water. Open the valve at the bottom of the tank. Collect the water in a clean storage container. It may contain rust and/or sediment. Filter using a clean towel/sock/coffee filter.

Step 7: Treat the water. Add bleach, stir, and let stand for 30 minutes.

- Regular bleach (5.25%) – add 8 drops per gallon.
- Concentrated bleach (8.25%) – add 5 drops per gallon.

*Allow the tank to **fill completely BEFORE** turning on power to the water heater!

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